

numbering, respectively. Another useful one is `\begin{block}-end{block}` environment, which helps highlight a specific piece of text. For example (results shown in Figure 2):

```
\begin{frame}
\frametitle{Introduction}
\framesubtitle{Hello World Tutorial}
\begin{block}{Beamer}
Hello World from Beamer
\end{block}
\end{frame}
```

Beamer has some built-in environments for definitions, theorems, lemma, proofs, corollaries, examples, etc, which we can use instead of using the *block* environment. For example we can create an example block as follows:

```
\begin{example}
Hello World from Beamer
\end{example}
```

To add a table of contents, you can use the `\tableofcontents` environment inside a *frame*. Content information is taken from `\section{}` parts in the document. Beamer lets you give extra options within `[]`. For example, to list the table of contents sections one after another, you can add the `[pausesections]` option to `\tableofcontents`, as follows: `\tableofcontents[pausesections]`. Options can be used elsewhere too—for example, for a custom title and author name in the footer section, use the following commands:

```
\documentclass{beamer}
\usetheme{Warsaw}
\title{Beamer Intro}[Beamer - Introduction to \LaTeX presentation making]
\author{J E S T I N}[Jestin Joy]
```

Overlays are used extensively when creating a MS PowerPoint presentation. Beamer also has overlay functionality, usually used along with the *itemize* or *enumerate* environment:

```
\begin{frame}
\begin{example}
Some good Latex Editors are
\begin{itemize}
\item<2-> Texmaker
\item<3-> Emacs + AUXTX
\item<4-> Kile
\end{itemize}
\end{example}
\end{frame}
```

Here, the overlay specifications are used with the *itemize*

environment, which displays data in a list. The numbers `<2->`, `<3->`,... represent the order in which they are to be displayed. If `<1->` is given, then the Texmaker option comes in the first time itself. The number of slides needed is automatically computed by Beamer. The above frame needs four slides in total. A simple *.tex* file that includes the above techniques follows:

```
\documentclass{beamer}
\usetheme{Warsaw}
\title{Beamer Intro}[Beamer - Introduction to \LaTeX presentation making]
\author{J E S T I N}[Jestin Joy]
\begin{document}
\begin{frame}
\titlepage
\end{frame}
\begin{frame}
\frametitle{Outline}
\tableofcontents[pausesections]
\end{frame}
\section{Introduction}
\begin{frame}
\frametitle{Introduction}
\framesubtitle{Hello World Tutorial}
\begin{example}
Hello World from Beamer
\end{example}
\end{frame}
\section{Itemize example}
\begin{frame}
\begin{example}
Some good Latex Editors are
\begin{itemize}
\item<2-> Texmaker
\item<3-> Emacs + AUXTX
\item<4-> Kile
\end{itemize}
\end{example}
\end{frame}
\end{document}
```

Beamer's features are not limited to what's been covered in this article, but include embedding dynamic effects, customising themes, layouts, fonts, and more. So... since we have almost tamed Beamer, go start playing with it. **END** 

By: Jestin Joy

The author got inspired by GNU/Linux during his B.Tech days at the College of Engineering, Chengannur, Kerala. He strongly believes free software can be utilised for the upliftment of the mankind. Now, working as lecturer in the Federal Institute of Science and Technology, Kerala, he extensively uses software like GNU/Linux, LaTeX and Scilab in teaching.